THE GREAT PAST-TENSE MYSTERY

3rd Year Spanish | Independent cover lesson | About 50 minutes

Name: _____ Class: _____

Yesterday was a strange day at school. Your mission: solve the grammar challenges and find out what happened. Work in order, write your answers on these pages, and use your textbook table on p. 264 if you need help.

1. Detective warm-up	7 min
2. What really happened?	12 min
3. Grammar police	10 min
4. The alibi	8 min
5. Your ridiculous story	13 min

MISSION 1 | DETECTIVE WARM-UP

Suggested time: 7 minutes

Match each infinitive to the correct yo form in the past. Write the letter. Two verbs share the same form: can you spot them?

1. tener _____ A. pude

2. hacer _____ B. dije

3. estar _____ C. fui

4. poder _____ D. estuve

5. decir _____ E. quise

6. venir _____ F. hice

7. poner _____ G. tuve

8. querer _____ H. puse

9. ir _____ I. vine

10. ser _____

Bonus: Which two infinitives have the same yo form? _____

MISSION 2 | WHAT REALLY HAPPENED?

Suggested time: 12 minutes

Complete each sentence using the correct pretérito indefinido form of the verb in brackets. Pay attention to the subject.

1. Ayer el Sr. Martín no _____ en clase. (estar)

2. Nosotros _____ un examen sorpresa el lunes. (tener)

3. ¿Tú _____ los deberes anoche? (hacer)

4. Mis amigos _____ al comedor, pero estaba cerrado. (ir)

5. Yo _____ una gaviota dentro del instituto. (ver)

6. La profesora _____: «¡Silencio, por favor!». (decir)

7. Vosotros _____ los libros encima de la mesa. (poner)

8. Ana no _____ venir a clase porque perdió el autobús. (poder)

9. Mis padres _____ a recogerme a las cuatro. (venir)

10. Yo _____ un mensaje muy raro ayer. (leer)

11. El examen _____ más fácil de lo esperado. (ser)

12. ¿Vosotros _____ ir al cine el sábado? (querer)

MISSION 3 | GRAMMAR POLICE

Suggested time: 10 minutes

Most sentences contain one incorrect past-tense verb. Underline it and rewrite the whole sentence correctly.

1. Ayer yo tení tres clases de español.

Correction: _____

2. El Sr. Martín hació una pregunta muy difícil.

Correction: _____

3. Nosotros estuvimos en el gimnasio ayer.

Correction: _____

4. Mis amigos dicieron que el ventilador estaba roto.

Correction: _____

5. Tú poniste el móvil en la mochila.

Correction: _____

6. El sábado yo fui al cine y vido una película.

Correction: _____

Attention: One sentence is already correct. Write Correct! on its line.

MISSION 4 | THE ALIBI

Suggested time: 8 minutes. Translate these sentences into Spanish. Use the irregular verb table on page 264 if needed.

Mr Martín was not at school yesterday.

_____

We did our homework, but the dog ate it.

_____

They said the classroom was too hot.

_____

I saw a seagull and I ran away. (If you do not know “ran away”, translate the first clause.)

_____

MISSION 5 | THREE VERY NORMAL DAYS AT ARDGILLAN

Three strange stories. Each one has a beginning, a problem and an ending. Complete the two challenges for each story.

1. MATCH: Connect the Spanish sentences A–E to their English meanings 1–5. 2. ORDER: Put the Spanish letters in the correct story order (1–5). Use the English meanings to help you.

Tip: Some sentences include vocabulary you have not studied. Use the translations as clues. Focus on recognising irregular past-tense verbs.

STORY A | MR MARTÍN AND NASA

A. Aceptó el trabajo, pero puso una condición muy importante.	1. He wanted to keep teaching Spanish to 3rd Year G three times a week.
B. Ayer el Sr. Martín vino al colegio vestido de astronauta.	2. He told us NASA offered him the job of director.
C. La NASA dijo que sí y le dio un cohete para venir al colegio.	3. NASA said yes and gave him a rocket to come to school.
D. Nos dijo que la NASA le ofreció el puesto de director.	4. Yesterday Mr Martín came to school dressed as an astronaut.
E. Quiso seguir enseñando español a 3rd Year G tres veces por semana.	5. He accepted the job, but set one very important condition.

MATCH A → ____ B → ____ C → ____ D → ____ E → ____

STORY ORDER 1 → ____ 2 → ____ 3 → ____ 4 → ____ 5 → ____

Why was Mr Martín's condition so important? _____

STORY B | THE CHICKEN WRAP MYSTERY

A. La directora vino al comedor y quiso comprar veinte.	1. But the last chicken wrap mysteriously disappeared.
B. Ayer el chicken wrap del comedor ganó el premio al mejor de Balbriggan.	2. All the teachers queued for two hours to buy one.
C. Al final, lo encontraron en el mini frigorífico de la clase de español. El Sr. Martín no dijo nada.	3. In the end, they found it in the mini fridge in the Spanish classroom. Mr Martín said nothing.
D. Todos los profesores hicieron cola durante dos horas para comprar uno.	4. Yesterday the canteen chicken wrap won the award for the best in Balbriggan.
E. Pero el último chicken wrap desapareció misteriosamente.	5. The principal came to the canteen and wanted to buy twenty.

MATCH A → ____ B → ____ C → ____ D → ____ E → ____

STORY ORDER 1 → ____ 2 → ____ 3 → ____ 4 → ____ 5 → ____

Who do you think took the wrap? _____

STORY C | THE DAY STUDENTS TOOK OVER

A. Un profesor tuvo detention porque no llevó el uniforme.	1. The Irish teacher arrived late and had to find the head girl.
B. Ayer los alumnos fueron profesores y los profesores fueron alumnos.	2. At break, the teachers played football and did not want to return to class.
C. Al final, un profesor quiso ir al baño, pero un alumno le dijo que tenía que esperar hasta el recreo.	3. In the end, a teacher wanted to go to the toilet, but a student told him he had to wait until break.
D. Durante el recreo, los profesores jugaron al fútbol y no quisieron volver a clase.	4. Yesterday the students were teachers and the teachers were students.
E. La profesora de irlandés llegó tarde y tuvo que buscar a la head girl.	5. A teacher got detention because he did not wear the uniform.

MATCH A → ____ B → ____ C → ____ D → ____ E → ____

STORY ORDER 1 → ____ 2 → ____ 3 → ____ 4 → ____ 5 → ____

Which part of the role reversal is funniest? _____

MISSION 5 | YOUR ALTERNATIVE ENDING

Choose ONE of the three stories. Rewrite its ending in Spanish using 2–3 sentences. Try to use at least two irregular past-tense verbs (e.g. fue, tuvo, quiso, dijo, vino, puso, hizo). Underline them.

My story: A / B / C (circle one)

My new ending:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

FINAL QUESTION (IN ENGLISH): Which story is the most believable? Why?

_____

_____